

Literature

Poetry Study
General Lit.
History of Lit
Plays
Poetry Reading





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): General Lit.: Grades 9-10, History of Lit: Grades 9-12, Plays: Grades 9-12, Poetry Study: Grade 9, Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

About Poetry Study: Grade 9

Continuing in their poetry studies, students review a wide variety of poetic forms, learn how they have evolved over the centuries, and practice writing their own poems.

About General Lit.: Grades 9-10

Journey into the 19th century with novels, short stories, personal narratives, fairy tales, and more. Students engage with a variety of authors and texts from the time period and reflect on literary techniques and the characteristics of multiple genres along the way.

About History of Lit: Grades 9-12

Using Marshall's and Long's spines along with a variety of primary sources and additional readings, the History of Literature course introduces students to literary movements and figures in the 19th century. The course prioritizes influential texts in the English-speaking world but also seeks to give students glimpses at literary developments across the globe.

About Plays: Grades 9-12

Students read Shakespeare's plays with additional optional readings and extra helpings from the time period.

About Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

In addition to reading a variety of poems from 19th century authors, students read biographies of two famous 19th century poets and dive into Virgil's Aeneid.

Plays: Grades 9-12

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) is perhaps the greatest writer in the English language. Reading and speaking his beautiful words will delight students as they learn his timeless stories, meet a variety of characters, enrich their minds, and instruct their consciences. Students will begin by simply enjoying the plays and later by writing short compositions, comparisons, and commonplace entries. Shakespeare covers the wide panorama of human experience through his nearly 40 plays; the comedies, tragedies, and histories that students read will spark their imaginations with stories that transcend time and culture.



Placement & Combining Tips

Poetry Study: Grade 9

Prerequisite: Grade 8 Poetry Study or a working knowledge of poetic forms and terminology.

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

Suitable for hungry 8th graders. Can be combined easily with Grades 11-12.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

Lessons are shared across high school grades with grade-specific assignments in the lesson plans as appropriate.

Plays: Grades 9-12

This year, this course is the same as Shakespeare for Grades 5-8 with the only difference coming in Extra Helpings and additional options for further study.

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Students new or struggling in their relationship with poetry should use Grade 8 lessons.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Poetry Study: Grade 9 2 times/week 15 min	The Making of a Poem
9-10	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 2 times/week 30 min	Frankenstein Silas Marner Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass The Souls of Black Folk Up from Slavery Short stories and other writings
9-12	History of Lit: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	American Literature English Literature for Boys and Girls History of Literature PDF
9-12	Plays: Grades 9-12 1 time/week 30 min	The Tempest The Tempest (Audio recording) Henry IV Part 2 Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording) The Winter's Tale The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)
9-12	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 2 times/week 15 min	Poetry The Aeneid The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar The Crescent Moon

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grade 9				
History of Lit: Grades 9-12 Poetry Study: Grade 9		General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Poetry Study: Grade 9	Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12	General Lit.: Grades 9-10 Plays: Grades 9-12 Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

☐ For Term 1, read the translator's Preface (p.I-XXIII) to Celebrated Cases of Judge Dee and the Introduction (p.3-21) to Scarlet Letter to have enough context for the story to engage in discussion with your student(s) even if you are not able to read the full books. Reading Like a Serpent (linked in Extra Helpings) is also an excellent resource for students and teachers wishing to dive deeper into The Scarlet Letter.

☐ A Tale of Two Cities (Term 3) is a long novel, and to allow students to digest, write narrations, and enjoy the story, only about half of it is scheduled over the term. If you wish students to finish it, consider starting the book in Term 2 after the Gulliver's Travels lessons OR allowing students to read the book on their own time if interested (during or after the end of the term).

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

☐ Print off the History of Literature PDF, as students will need to annotate and mark up various sections throughout the year.

☐ Although sources were condensed into one PDF when possible, there are still quite a few outside links due to the number of primary sources referenced, so make sure your student(s) has/have access to the internet for their course.

Plays: Grades 9-12

- ☐ You may want to read "Shakespeare and a Christian Worldview," which is Ch.9 in the book Echoes of Eden – Reflections on Christianity, Literature, and the Arts by Jerram Barrs. This is an excellent overview of why Shakespeare is important for everyone to know, including Christians.
- ☐ If your students are new to Shakespeare, read the tips for beginners (Found in Appendix link)
- ☐ You may want to read a retelling beforehand so you are familiar with the play. (Suggestions found in Extra Helpings)
- ☐ Read the discussion questions and skim the summaries of each scene each week before the reading to help guide emphasis and discussion with your students.
- ☐ Consider purchasing puppets to use while reading to keep track of all the characters.

NOTE on VERSIONS

Students should have an unabridged copy that is not in a modern language edition, such as the ones linked in the program. The language complexity gets easier to understand with practice. (Note: Shakespeare's work does often contain bawdy jokes or off-color content that will go over the heads of students if left in its original form; a modern language version will lay it all right out there in plain, modern English.) We like the Folger editions because they are inexpensive, the lines are numbered (making it easy to find your place), and they contain good notes. These are available on the Folger website as free PDFs as well, though the notes are omitted.

NOTE on CONTENT

Teachers are sometimes wary of reading Shakespeare with their students because the plays do contain material that they would deem inappropriate. The Alveary generally follows Mason's programs for younger students. That does not mean, however, that your student will never encounter anything unsavory. Our best advice is to read in such a way that these things are moved over quickly, without added attention being drawn to them. Mason assures us that Shakespeare provides students with rich language and character lessons that are unparalleled.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Literature: Grade 9

Poetry Study: Grade 9



The Making of a Poem

General Lit.: Grades 9-10



Frankenstein



Silas Marner



Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass



The Souls of Black Folk



Up from Slavery

Short stories and other writings

History of Lit: Grades 9-12



American Literature



English Literature for Boys and Girls



History of Literature PDF

Plays: Grades 9-12



The Tempest



The Tempest (Audio recording)



Henry IV Part 2



Henry IV Part 2 (Audio recording)



The Winter's Tale



The Winter's Tale (Audio recording)

Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12

Poetry



The Aeneid



The Lightning Dreamer: Cuba's Greatest Abolitionist



Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar



The Crescent Moon



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grade 9

- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- ∞ [History of Literature PDF](#)

Plays: Grades 9-12

- ∞ [Appendix: Ideas for Students New to Shakespeare](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Literature: Grade 9

How To Approach



Read

The lesson plans will guide you through what to read over the terms. Take a moment before reading to remember where you left off last time.



Narrate

The lesson plans will give you specific instructions or tell you to choose a way to narrate that helps you interact with the ideas.



Discuss

The lesson plans will guide you with questions or instructions to share your ideas or what you are reading with others.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. Accountability components are occasionally added to facilitate teacher/student discussion and growing independence.

It is also valuable for those in a classroom setting to have a mix of lessons that students complete themselves silently and others read aloud and narrate together. Literature lessons lend themselves well to a larger discussion time at the end of the lesson where student can share their ideas.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Introduction - Romanticism

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

What authors and books come to mind when you think about literature in 19th century? You may be familiar with terms such as the "Romantic period" or "Victorian period." Tell or jot down anything that comes to mind.

Over the year we'll learn about the lives and writings of people who wrote from about 1800-1900 AD. These individuals wrote in a wide array of genres: poetry, essays, short stories, plays, science fiction, mysteries, thrillers, children's stories, and more. When possible, the readings scheduled in History of Lit will align with what you are reading in your Poetry and General Literature courses.

We'll focus on authors who wrote in English but will also spend some time getting a taste for influential texts written in other languages as well. Every culture has significant texts and stories, so while we're limited in this course to English texts and texts translated into English, it's important to remember there is a world of books and literary traditions from cultures around the world which we don't have the time or often the language to read in this course!

English writings from the end of the 18th century into the first half of the 19th century are sometimes grouped together as part of the "Romantic Period." As with any generalization, this is a label scholars have put on the time frame as they look back, not something authors were so much thinking about consciously as they wrote, although as we will see, writers and poets from this period were often aware that their style of writing was something new.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: History of Lit PDF "The Romantic Period" p.#-# (7 pages)

- What are some of the themes to look out for when you read literature from the Romantic Period? How did Romantic writers break with the traditions of Classicism? Do you recognize any ideas about poets and poetry in this reading that are still current today? How would you say our time is different or similar? What "rules" define literature written in English today?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

Transition from Classicism to Romanticism

→ INTRO

Towards the end of the eighteenth century, writers were beginning to break from the rules of Classicism and experiment with poetic subject matter and form that, in retrospect, seem more aligned with the themes of Romanticism. Today, you will read a few works by three poets who bridge these two time periods: Thomas Gray, William Cowper, and Robert Burns.

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard

- What is the setting of the poem, and how does Gray use this setting to create a mood or tone for the poem? What do you think the poet is saying about death and memory?

∞ Link: The Shrubbery

- How does the speaker show that there is a disconnect between how he feels and where he is? What is his relationship to the nature he sees around him?



Term 1

∞ Link: To a Mouse

- If the language seems hard, try reading it out loud!
- This poem ends with a turn - why does the speaker see the mouse as "blest, compar'd wi' me!"?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 1

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ INTRO

Mary Shelley's *Frankenstein* has had a continuous influence on the wider culture since its publication over two centuries ago. Sir Walter Scott pronounced it "extraordinary" and declared that Shelley possessed "uncommon powers of poetic imagination." The story has been told and retold through many adaptations and artistic forms; however, there is a disconnect between the cartoonish, green-faced Frankenstein monster familiar to most of us, and Shelley's tale of a nameless monster created by Dr. Frankenstein. Karen Swallow Prior writes that the novel "is full of surprises for the first-time reader." Rather than a straightforward monster story, it is "in the strain of the philosophical novel. Readers expecting merely an entertaining tale of horror can expect to be confronted with big ideas and big questions" (14).

→ READ & NARRATE

p.1-7 "You will rejoice to hear" - "bless my beloved sister!"

- Notice that the novel opens with a series of letters. There will be many narrative frames throughout the novel as characters tell stories within stories, so paying attention to point-of-view is very important. What do you learn of Robert Walton from these opening pages?
- What tone is set by the opening line?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth

→ INTRO

We will learn more about William Wordsworth (1770-1850) in the History of Literature lesson next week, but today's reading should give you a feel for his style and major themes. As you read, compare Wordsworth's poem to the selections you read last time. "Tintern Abbey" is written in blank verse (unrhymed iambic pentameter, or ten syllables per line). What other poets have you read that use blank verse? How is this different than Gray's "Elegy" you read last week, that had a very rigid structure?

∞ Link: Lines Composed a Few Miles above Tintern Abbey, On Revisiting the Banks of the Wye during a Tour. July 13, 1798

- What are some images that especially stand out to you? What is Wordsworth saying about nature?
- What do you think he means when he says in lines 64-67: "here I stand, not only with the sense / Of present pleasure, but with pleasing thoughts / That in this moment there is life and food / For future years."?

→ VIEW

Look at this painting of Tintern Abbey painted in 1804 by English landscape painter William Havell (1782-1857).

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 2



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

The Villanelle

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

This book introduces several poetic forms. Many of you will already know. However, some will be new, and there are still more that time won't allow us to cover. The anthology takes us further into the history of how those forms developed over the centuries, each new generation of poets dialoguing with those in the past. Along the way, you will read many different examples of each form, and you'll write your own poems as well.

→ READ

- p.xiii "This book" - "single poetic form."
- p.3-7 "Overview", "The Villanelle At-a-Glance", and "The History of the Form"

→ NARRATE

- Jot down a few ideas from your reading.
- Read "The House on the Hill" by Edwin Arlington Robinson on p.9-10. Then look at p.5, "The Villanelle At-a-Glance", and see if you can identify each of the poetic features listed in Robinson's poem. You may want to highlight, underline, or color-code the different features you find to help you notice and remember.

• COMPOSITION ACTIVITY

Over the year, you'll create your own reference book for the various poetic forms you study. The purpose is for you to have a quick guide that makes sense to you and is easy to pull up or keep on hand as you read individual poems. Start by creating your own "At-a-Glance" for the Villanelle. Here are a few of the possibilities:

- Copy the "Villanelle At-a-Glance" into a designated space in a notebook or a document on a device where you can easily find and reference it in the future. Add any additional notes for yourself that you'd like.
- Draw an illustration or create an infographic in Canva (or similar design software) showing the form more visually.
- Create a PowerPoint and create your own Villanelle At-a-Glance for the first slide (using text and/or visuals).
- Something else! Get creative!

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Reading Villanelles

Materials: The Making of a Poem, poetry notebook (opt.)

→ INTRO

Refresh your memory with the "Villanelle At-a-Glance" on p.5 and read the following villanelles aloud. Think about the following questions as you read. You may want to keep your poetry notebook nearby or write in the margins of your book to track your thinking.

- What words strike you?
- What lines sound particularly odd?
- What reactions do you have as you read?
- Do all these poets follow the "rules" for villanelles, or do they bend them a bit? Playing with rules is part of the poet's business.

Naturalist Jack Laws encourages us to view nature by asking ourselves, "What do I notice?", "What do I wonder?", and "What does this remind me of?" We can ask these same questions of stories and poems as well. Read these poems actively! Again, you may want to keep your poetry notebook nearby or write in the margins of your book to track your thinking as you read the next poems in this lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- p.11-12 "The Waking," "One Art," and "Do Not Go Gentle into That Good Night"
- p.14 "By the Sound"

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls; History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the major themes of the Romantic Period from last week's reading?

→ INTRO

Today we will learn more about the life and work of two poets - William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge, who are most closely associated with English Romantic poetry.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Marshall, Ch.LXXIV "Wordsworth - the Poet of Nature."
 - How did Wordsworth's experiences as a child seem to influence his later poetry?
2. Marshall, Ch.LXXV "Wordsworth and Coleridge - the Lake Poets."
 - What are some similarities and differences between the two poets?

• IMPORTANT DATES

William Wordsworth (1770-1850)

Samuel Taylor Coleridge (1772-1834)

First publication of the Lyrical Ballads (1798)

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

William Wordsworth and Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

With the anonymous publication in 1798 of their Lyrical Ballads, Wordsworth and Coleridge introduced a new style of poetry to the public. The initial publication received mixed reviews, however, and with each subsequent publication, the two poets included a Preface by way of an introduction to their style, themes, and purpose. In today's lesson, you will read excerpts from the 1802 edition of this preface, as well as a representative poem by each of them. Think about how the poetry you read illustrates some of the points made in the Preface.

→ READ & DISCUSS

1. ∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads (1802)
2. Wordsworth, "My Heart Leaps Up"

My heart leaps up when I behold
A rainbow in the sky:
So was it when my life began;
So is it now I am a man;
So be it when I shall grow old,
Or let me die!
The Child is father of the Man;
And I could wish my days to be
Bound each to each by natural piety.
3. ∞ Link: Wordsworth, "I Wandered Lonely As A Cloud"
4. ∞ Link: Coleridge, "The Rime of the Ancient Mariner"
 - NOTE: This poem is too long to read completely today, but reading it for a few minutes will give you a feel for the style. If you enjoy it, please finish reading it during the next poetry class or during your free reading time!



Term 1

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 3

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.8-14 ""So strange an accident" - "and wrecked it - thus!"

- How are the gigantic creature and the stranger introduced? What questions do you have at this point in the novel?
- What are Walton's impressions of his guest? Why would Shelley introduce the title character to her readers through another character?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Samuel Taylor Coleridge

→ INTRO

Today we are going to read a poem much different in style from The Rime of the Ancient Mariner. As you read, think about other poems you have read about children, or by poets remembering their own childhood.

∞ Link: Frost at Midnight

With any time remaining, you can read more of The Rime of the Ancient Mariner.

★ TEACHER TIP

There is a Poem Guide for Frost at Midnight at the Poetry Foundation link, if your student would like extra information about the poem or help with understanding it.

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 4

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

More Villanelles

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ

p.18 "Villanelle for the Middle of the Night"

p.19-20 "Close-up of a Villanelle"

∞ Article Link: Villanelle by Andrew Lang

∞ Article Link: A Dainty Thing's the Villanelle by W.E. Henley

→ DISCUSS

- Which of the villanelles that you've read is your favorite? Why?
- The villanelle has been called the "poetry of loss" because of the way the repeated lines can build an echo of sadness. However, as you previously read, the villanelle originated from lighter ballads and songs and has also been used for lighter and happier topics (several of the ones you read today). What topics do you think the villanelle fits best?

• COMPOSITION

Start writing your own villanelle. Refer to your At-a-Glance guide and the villanelles you have read as needed.

Reference: Making of a Poem

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 4

The Sestina

Materials: The Making of a Poem, copies of poems (opt.)

→ INTRO

You'll read a variety of sestinas over the next few lessons. Sestinas are a pretty complicated poetic form (they show the poet/singer's mastery!), so it's ok if it takes a bit of time to make sense of the patterns. You may want to print off some of the poems or mark them up in your book to help you notice the various features of the genre (along with your other thoughts).



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.21-24 "The Sestina At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

→ READ

Read the poem aloud to better hear the words since it is from the 1500s and the spelling is not the same as today (Edmund Spenser is a famous English poet from that time).

p.25-26 "Ye wastefull woodes, bear witness of my woe"

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

Rabindranath Tagore

→ INTRO

If you are taking the Poetry Reading course this year, you will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century.

→ VIEW, NARRATE & DISCUSS

This video provides an excellent overview of Tagore's life and work. It will take nearly the entire lesson time to watch, although you can watch at 1.25x speed.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate

- What were some of Tagore's major contributions to arts and history?

→ READ

∞ Link: The Gardener 85

This short poem is a timely piece to read, since Tagore was still alive and writing a century ago.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Rabindranath Tagore (1861-1941)

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Rabindranath Tagore

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ INTRO

We will spend much of Term 1 reading poems by the Bengali writer, philosopher and artist Rabindranath Tagore, who was born in 1861 in Calcutta, India, and grew up in a family that loved art, music, and ideas. He wrote in Bengali, but translated his own works into English. He is a significant figure for Indian nationalism, and, though not himself a politician, was a vocal proponent of India's independence at the turn of the twentieth century. In 1913, he became the first non-European writer to be awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature. He also composed the national anthems for both India and Bangladesh, making his words a lasting part of two nations.

The Crescent Moon is a collection of forty poems exploring themes such as childhood wonder, the natural world, imagination. As you read through these poems, think about other poems you have read that present the world through the eyes of children, such as Robert Louis Stevenson's *A Child's Garden of Verses*.

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

p.6-7 "The Home"

- How would you describe the speaker of this poem?
- The poem opens with two examples of personification (a figure of

★ TEACHER NOTE

If you are not taking the History of Lit 9-12 course, you may wish to watch this introduction to the life and work of Rabindranath Tagore during some free time.

∞ Video Link: Rabindranath Tagore – Mystic Poet, Literary Genius & Nobel Laureate



Term 1

speech which gives human characteristics to non-human things). Why do you think Tagore uses these images of a miser and a widow?

p.8 "On the Seashore"

- What images stand out most to you in this poem? How might they be symbols of a deeper meaning that lies beneath a simple description of children playing?

p.9-10 "The Source" and "Baby's Way"

- What do these two poems together seem to say about the nature of infants and children?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 5

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.14-21 "I am by birth a Genevese" - "the greatest avidity."

- Describe the circumstances of Victor's parentage, his childhood, and his education.
- How does Victor recall his first reading of Agrippa? Does this foreshadow any of what is to come? Look for other instances of foreshadowing as you read.

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.11-16

p.12-13 "Sleep-Stealer"

- Do you think someone really stole the baby's sleep?
- What phrase is repeated throughout the poem? Why do you think this is?
- How does the poem blur the line between the real world and the imaginative world?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 6

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

Reading Sestinas

Materials: The Making of a Poem, digital or physical notebook

→ INTRO

Read the following poems aloud once to simply enjoy the sound of the words and get the sense of the poem. Then read the poems again, looking more closely at the formal features of the poetry (pay special attention to the last words of each line, and watch the pattern). Finally, write questions or thoughts in your book or notebook.



Term 1

→ READ & NARRATE

p.29 "Sestina: Of the Lady Pietra degli Scrovigni (translation; the original is written in Italian by Dante Alighieri, who wrote the Divine Comedy)
p.30-31 "Sestina"

→ CREATE

Start creating your own "Sestina At-a-Glance" page for your reference guide in your digital or physical medium of choice.

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

More Sestinas

Materials: The Making of a Poem, digital or physical notebook used in the previous lesson

→ CREATE

Take a few minutes to finish creating your "Sestina At-a-Glance" page in your reference guide.

→ READ

p.32-35 "Sestina," "Sestina of the Tramp-Royal," and "Sestina: Altaforte"

(Note that part of the context for "Altaforte" is the poet imagining what a man known for stirring up strife might say. The man is based on a character in Dante's longer epic poem, the Divine Comedy, who was put in hell for stirring up strife).

→ NARRATE & DISCUSS

How would you describe the energy and emotion in each of the poems from today?

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

Sir Walter Scott

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

E.M. Forster described Sir Walter Scott as a writer "over whom we shall violently divide," and certainly he has had his share of ardent readers and detractors. But one reason his works are still appreciated, as the literary critic Walter Allen said, is that "without being in the strict sense an historian, he revolutionized the writing of history." Today we will learn more about this author whom Virginia Woolf described as "perhaps the last novelist to practice the great, the Shakespearean art, of making people reveal themselves in speech," and of whom Jane Austen said, "Walter Scott has no business to write novels, especially good ones. It is not fair. He has Fame and Profit enough as a Poet!"

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXVII "Scott - The Awakening of Romance
Ch.LXXVIII "Scott - 'The Wizard of the North'"

- What elements of Scott's subject matter and style seem distinctive to you?

→ READ

∞ Link: Lochinvar



Term 1

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.17-22

p. 19 "Playthings"

- How does the poem compare child's play to adult work, and which seems more satisfying?
- What "art" has the adult forgotten?
- What does the poem mean when it says adults spend their lives seeking "costly playthings"? Does this create success and happiness?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 7

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.21-29 "When I returned home" - "my future destiny."

- When Victor goes to university, how do his professors react to his course of study?
- Where do you see foreshadowing in today's reading? Since Victor is telling Walton (who is retelling his story to his sister) about his past from the vantage point of the future, how reliable is he as a narrator?

• COMPOSITION -

Compare/Contrast

Karen Swallow Prior observes that "The clash between ancient and modern science is part of a larger discussion during this period of modernity. How are these two schools contrasted and set against one another? How is the modern elevated above the ancient? Do we still see this kind of debate today? How so?"

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.23-29

p. 23-24 "Fairyland"

- Why do you think the child whispers the secret to the mother instead of telling everyone?
- In what ways can imagination transform ordinary places into something wondrous and special?

p. 28-29 "Paper Boats"

- What is inside the boat during the poem?
- What do you think the child imagines will happen to the paper boats on their journey?
- Why do you think the child hopes that "someone in some strange land" will find the boats?



Term 1

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.
• What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ VIEW

∞ Picture Link: Tulsi plant

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 8

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 7

Sestinas Continued

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.38-40 "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina" and "Nani"

∞ Article Link: Sestina by Elizabeth Bishop

- If you drew an illustration for each of these three poems, what would it be? Why?
- How do you imagine the speakers in "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina" and "Nani"? Who are they?
- How do you think the title and shape (literal shape and length of lines) relate to the words of the poem in "The Shrinking Lonesome Sestina"?

• COMPOSITION

Start writing your own sestina. Refer to your At-a-Glance guide and the sestinas you have read as needed. Because sestinas are fairly long and the form is complicated, you may not be able to finish your poem during the allotted time. Try to write at least two stanzas during the lesson and finish the poem on your own time if you like.

Reference: Making of a Poem

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 8

The Pantoum

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-45 "The Pantoum At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," and "The Contemporary Context"

p.47 "Pantoum of the Great Depression"

p.49-51 "Pantoum" and "Grandmother's Song"

You'll notice that not all of the Pantoums follow the "rules," especially the rules for the rhyme scheme.

- How would you describe the effect of this form?
- Why do you think the poets chose to break the "rules"?
- Do you hear the "mesmerizing chain of echoes" in these poems?

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

Percy Bysshe Shelley

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Sir Walter Scott from last week?

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley, wife of Mary Shelley (the author of *Frankenstein*). If you are also taking the Poetry course, you will read some of his poetry this week. However, today you will also read an excerpt from his *Defence of Poetry*, a philosophical essay on the nature and function of poets and poetry.

Do you recall any details about Shelley from the overview of the Romantic Period you read in Week 1?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Percy Bysshe Shelley Biography

• COMPOSITION -

Compare/Contrast

Compare and contrast what you read of Shelley's *Defence to the Preface to the Lyrical Ballads*.



Term 1

2. Defence of Poetry

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF

- What are the main points Shelley is making in this excerpt? What images and arguments stand out to you the most? What do you think he means by "poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world?"

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.30-35

p. 33-34 "The Merchant"

- What gifts would you bring home if you traveled to magical lands like the child in the poem?
- What do the different gifts chosen for the mother, father, and brother reveal about how the child sees each person?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ VIEW

∞ Picture Link: Shiuli flower (The English name is night-blooming jasmine.)

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 9

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's education from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.29-36 "From this day natural philosophy" - "Dante could not have conceived."

- What are some clues that Victor is transgressing a necessary and sacred ethical boundary with his research? If "a churchyard was to [him] merely the receptacle of bodies deprived of life" (30) what does this tell us about his view of human beings?
- How does Victor describe the final "accomplishment of [his] toils"? What is his reaction when he comes face to face with what he created? How does the creature react to him?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Percy Bysshe Shelley

→ INTRO

Today, we are turning our attention to the first of two second-generation Romantic poets: Percy Bysshe Shelley. While he was inspired by the work and thought of Wordsworth and Coleridge, he has a style all his own. Look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. The first two poems are sonnets: what do you already know about



Term 1

sonnets? How does the form support the meaning of the poem? Both these poems have guides, if you would like to read about them further.

∞ Link: Ozymandias

∞ Link: England in 1819

• What do you know about what was happening in English around the year 1819?

2. In these second two poems, consider how Shelley is representing nature.

∞ Link: Ode to the West Wind

∞ Link: Mont Blanc

• What poetic images stand out to you the most?

WEEK 5 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 10

WEEK 5 ☐ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 9

Writing a Pantoum

☐ Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ

∞ Article Link: I'm going to like it here (from Oscar and Hammerstein; a partial Pantoum)

→ WRITE

Write your own pantoum. Be sure to follow rule #3, but you can choose which of the other rules to keep or break as long as the poem still follows enough rules to be recognizable as a Pantoum.

WEEK 5 ☐ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 10

Introducing Sonnets

☐ Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ INTRO

For the rest of the term and into next, we'll be focusing on sonnets and some particularly famous sonneteers such as Petrarch, Shakespeare, John Donne, George Herbert, and others.

→ CREATE

Spend 5-10 minutes creating an "at-a-glance" for a Pantoum for a reference guide.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.55-59 "The Sonnet At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

NOTE: In #3 on p.55, the authors have conflated (combined) a third sonnet form with the Petrarchan. Don't worry about the details, but you'll want to ignore #3 in your book and focus on the two most common rhyme schemes listed below.

- Petrarchan: octave rhyming abba abba, followed by a set usually rhyming cdcdcd or cdecde.
- Shakespearean sonnet: rhyme scheme abab cdcd efef gg

WEEK 5 ☐ 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5



Term 1

WEEK 6 ☐ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Percy Bysshe Shelley from last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This article is fairly long. You may skim through the information about her early life with Percy Shelley, but be sure to read the excerpts of her travel writing and other prose towards the end of the article.

∞ Article Link: [Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley Biography](#)

- What aspects of Mary Shelley's character are evident in her writing? If you are reading *Frankenstein* this year, does knowing more about the author's life affect your reading of her work?

WEEK 6 ☐ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

☐ Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Shelley that you read in the last lesson?
What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.36-40

p. 36 "Vocation"

- Why does the child think the hawker, gardener, and watchman have exciting lives?
- How does the poem contrast school life with the child's longing for independence?
- What does the poem suggest about our tendency to imagine that other lives are freer or happier than our own?

p. 40 "Authorship"

- Did you catch the line about the child making a paper boat? Do you think this is the same child who made paper boats in a previous poem?
- What kinds of stories does the child wish the father would write?
- How does the poem show the difference between the way children and adults value work, play, and creativity?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 6 ☐ 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 11

Frankenstein

☐ Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the creature's first moments from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.36-43 "I passed the night wretchedly" - "I intreat you, write!"

- Throughout this process, Victor has isolated himself from friends and family and now refuses to confess to anyone what he has done. What does this say about his character, and how has it shaped his thinking and



Term 1

reactions?

- What news is contained in Elizabeth's letter? How does the story of Justine parallel other stories we have heard so far?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

John Keats

→ INTRO

Today, we will meet the second of the second-generation Romantic poets: John Keats. As we did with Shelley, look for some of the themes you've been learning about from the Romantic Period. There is only one poem to read today, because your understanding and appreciation of it will increase with multiple readings. Read it through more than once on your own, and if you would like some interpretive help, there is a link to a Guide to the poem.

∞ Link: Poem Guide: Ode on a Grecian Urn

This poem, Ode on a Grecian Urn, is a famous example of ekphrasis, or the poetic descriptions of a work of art. As you read, think about how the poetry engages with other arts, such as sculpture and music. What does it have to say about the limits of any one art form, or, put more bluntly, what can poetry do that sculpture can't, and vice versa?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Ode on a Grecian Urn

- The final enigmatic two lines have been an interpretive puzzle since Keats wrote this poem - what do you think he means by "Beauty is truth, truth beauty,—that is all / Ye know on earth, and all ye need to know." And why are they in quotation marks?

→ VIEW

It is helpful to have an image of what Keats is describing when reading the poem.

∞ Link: Sketch of an Urn by Keats

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 12

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 11

Petrarch's Life & Poetry

→ INTRO

As a literature scholar explains, "Sonnet" comes from an Italian word meaning 'little song,' and that from a Latin word meaning 'sound.' Keep this in mind as you read.

→ READ & DISCUSS

After reading a brief bio, start reading some of Petrarch's sonnets. Read them aloud.

∞ Article Link: Petrarch Bio

∞ Article Link: Petrarch's Sonnets, Sonnet I, VI, VIII, X, XII, and XV

- Look more closely at one or two sonnets. Look at both the Italian and English versions. Can you see the rhyme pattern?
- Count the lines and find where the octave ends and the sestet begins. Can you see the shift, sometimes called the "volta", in the poem's tone or argument? What is it?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 12

More Petrarch

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Pick a few other Petrarchan sonnets from a different translation to read.

∞ Article Link: More Petrarch Sonnets

• COMPOSITION

Some have called Petrarch's Sonnets the 14th-century equivalent of pop songs today. Compare and contrast the two. Would you agree or disagree with this comparison?



Term 1

- Look more closely at Sonnet XII. Based on the other sonnets you've read by Petrarch, what do you think about his claim that his far-off love, Laura, "points [him] to heaven"?

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

John Keats

Materials: English Literature for Boys and Girls

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXI "Keats - The Poet of Beauty"

- What are some connections between Keats and other writers you have studied this term? Which excerpts of his writing did you enjoy the most in today's reading?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.41-46

p. 49 "The Banyan Tree". The Banyan tree is the national tree of India.

- Why do you think the child wants to be the wind, a bird, or a duck?
- How does the poem show movement through the images?
- What might the child learn from quietly watching nature every day?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Parable of the Banyan Tree

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 13

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's state of mind from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.43-50 "Dear, dear Elizabeth!" - "not murdered my brother?"

- How does Victor now spend his time? Nature seems to have a way of restoring his "health and spirits," but do you find his description of nature as "inanimate" to be concerning (45)? How do his views of nature align or contrast with the view of nature put forth by Romanticism?
- What is the symbolism of the storm, and why is Victor so insistent on watching it rather than rushing home to his family?
- What do we learn about the creature with this next sighting of him?



Term 1

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

John Keats, cont.

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Link: Ode to a Nightingale

• What does the nightingale represent to Keats in this poem?

2. The other two poems by Keats are both sonnets written in response to other works of art. The first he wrote after reading George Chapman's translation of Homer, and the second in response to the Elgin Marbles (statuaries from the Parthenon) when they first were displayed at the British Museum.

∞ Link: On First Looking into Chapman's Homer

∞ Link: On Seeing the Elgin Marbles

→ VIEW

A slide show of the sculptures that Keats would have seen.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles at the British Library

• EXTRA HELPING

The Elgin Marbles are controversial, and Greece has requested their repatriation. Read more about the controversy here.

∞ Link: The Elgin Marbles

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 14

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 13

Shakespeare Wrote Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ CREATE

Add an "At-a-glance" page to your reference guide for the Petrarchan Sonnet. Refer to p.55 "Sonnet At-a-Glance" and Lesson 10. You can combine your section on the Petrarchan sonnet with a section on Shakespearean sonnets, like our book does, or make two separate sections. Time will be allotted in other lessons to work on the details for the Shakespearean sonnet.

→ READ

p.59 "Shall I compare thee to a summer's day?"

In addition to his famous plays, Shakespeare is known for his sonnets--so much so that his name designates the unique form of the sonnet that became popular in England in the 16th century. If you have time remaining, pick a few sonnets to read for the rest of the lesson.

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets

Suggested: 8, 19, 23, 29, 55, 65, 73, 104, and 116

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 14

More Shakespearean Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

Instead of an octave of eight lines and a set of six like the Petrarchan sonnet, Shakespearean sonnets have three quatrains (four lines each) and then a final rhyming couplet. You can see the rhyme scheme on p.55. Notice that each of the quatrains starts a new set of rhyming lines.

Pick a few new sonnets to enjoy today, and then spend several minutes observing one or two more closely (particularly their structure and



Term 1

rhymes).

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets

Suggested Sonnets: 8, 19, 23, 29, 55, 65, 73, 104, and 116

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

→ INTRO

Today we will learn about a Romantic poet from another part of the world - Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda - who was born in Cuba and lived in Spain. She is the subject of *The Lightning Dreamer*, a biographical story told in poems, that you will begin to read this week if you are taking the Poetry Reading 9-12 course.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

- What aspects of her life made it difficult for her to be a poet? What aspects made it easier for her to be a poet than other women during this time period?
- The article describes her as "the epitome of the Romantic poet, the tragic heroine who rises to public acclaim yet, in private, is bitterly unhappy," which is a quotation from the preface to a 2001 edition of her novel *Sab*. Are there other Romantic poets you've learn about so far this term that you would describe the same way?
- What questions do you have about Avellaneda's life and work?

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: 10 Poems by Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

- What are your first impressions of her poetry? What subjects does she choose to write about?
- Do her poems remind you of anything else you've read?

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to a recitation of "To a Butterfly"

∞ **Video Link:** To A Butterfly by Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda

Materials: *Lightning Dreamer*

→ INTRO

Today we will begin a novel in verse about the Cuban-Spanish Romantic poet Gertrudis Gómez de Avellaneda (1814-1873) who used her writing to speak out against injustice of all kinds. If you have not read her biography already, it is linked below.

∞ Article Link: Biography of Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.169-174 "Historical Note"

p.ix "Historical Background"

p.3-10 "Books are door-shaped" - "like oxen or mules."

- Who are the people? Make a character list. Each week as you read, think about the different perspectives of the poems and how each one sees the same situation very differently. Share your observations in your narrations.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.



Term 1

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 15

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the circumstances surrounding William's death from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.50-58 "No one can conceive" - "yet I could not refuse."

- Why does Victor not tell anyone his story if it could save the life of Justine?
- What do we learn about the character of Elizabeth from today's reading?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: Lightning Dreamer

→ RECAP

What were your first impressions of these poems?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has he death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Continue to add to your character list.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 16

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 15

Sonnets 116 and 73

→ OBSERVE & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Shakespeare's Sonnets

Look at Sonnets 73 and 116 more closely.

- How many different word pictures can you find in the poems?
- Which ones stick out to you the most?
- Are any confusing?
- What kinds of emotions or thoughts do the images evoke?
- Describe the tone of the poems.
- Notice the rhyme scheme of the poems. Do they follow the Shakespearean form laid out in The Making of a Poem, p.55?
- Explain the first four lines of Sonnet 116 in your own words. What is Shakespeare saying about the nature of love? Do you agree?

Shakespearean sonnets are often written in iambic pentameter, which is a cadence natural to English. Choose either Sonnet 73 or 116 and count the syllables of each line, then read the poem aloud and listen for the stressed syllables.

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

The questions and activities in this lesson can be completed orally, in a group discussion, in writing, or even through sketches or other forms. Students should use whatever medium will best allow them to engage more deeply with these sonnets.

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 16

Add to Your Reference Guide

Materials: your reference guide

→ CREATE

Add an at-a-glance section on the Shakespearean Sonnet to your reference guide, referring back to sonnets you've read, these lessons, and your book as desired.

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

José María Heredia

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda's life and poetry?

→ INTRO

As a child in Cuba, Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda was tutored by the Cuban Romantic poet José María Heredia. Today we will learn more about him and read two selections of his poetry. If you are reading *The Lightning Dreamer*, you will discover just how much an influence Heredia had on Gertrudis Gomez de Avellaneda's development as a writer and thinker.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Biography of José María Heredia

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: Niagara

∞ Link: The Hurricane

- How would you describe the mood of these poems?
- What does Niagara Falls and The Hurricane symbolize in these poems?
- Do these poems remind you of any others you have read this year?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Lightning Dreamer, cont.

Materials: *Lightning Dreamer*

→ RECAP

What do you recall from

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.11-24 "I feel like a new person" - "dark or light."

- How are the nuns able to support Tula?
- How did Tula's father influence her, and how has he death shaped who she is at thirteen?
- Continue to add to your character list.
- How do the alternating viewpoints allow the poems to speak to each other. Look for poems that discuss the same topic but from different perspectives.

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 17

Frankenstein

Materials: *Frankenstein*

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the circumstances surrounding William's death



Term 1

from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.58-65 "We entered the gloomy prison" - "giver of oblivion."

- From Karen Swallow Prior: "What is Justine's place in the family? What is her character like? How does her presence invoke issues of class and economic status?"
- Victor reflects: "Despair! Who dared talk of that? The poor victim, who on the morrow was to pass the awful boundary between life and death, felt not, as I did, such deep and bitter agony." What do you make of this? What does it say about Victor's sense of himself?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.
p.47-50

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 18

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 17

John Donne's Holy Sonnets

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

John Donne lived during Shakespeare's time and took the sonnet form in a new direction as he built upon the tradition of both Petrarch and (what was coming to be known as) the Shakespearean sonnet. He was a poet and a priest, and instead of the flowing (and sometimes tearful) love poetry of Petrarch or Shakespeare, some of Donne's best-known sonnets are addressed to God rather than to a woman and contain unexpected rhythms and images. Pick a few sonnets to read aloud today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets
Suggested Sonnets: VII, X, XIV, XV, XIX

- How would you describe John Donne based on what you've read in these poems?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 18

More Donne

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Continue reading Donne's sonnets. Finish reading the suggested sonnets from the last lesson.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Benjamin Britten set some of Donne's sonnets to music!

∞ Audio Link: Britten's Holy Sonnets

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Suggested Sonnets: VII, X, XIV, XV, XIX

- What lines do you think are most interesting or striking?

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10

Felicia Dorothea Hemans

→ RECAP

Which of the two poems by Heredia that you read last week did you prefer?

→ INTRO

We're jumping back in time by a few decades today to meet Felicia Dorothea Hemans, an English Romantic poet who was wildly popular in her own day. She was read and admired by many poets you have been reading so far this term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Biography of Felicia Dorothea Hemans

- Writing allowed Hemans to provide for herself and her five sons after she was abandoned by her husband, but what were some ways that the challenges she faced negatively impacted her writing?
- Do you see any similarities in the biographies of Felicia Hemans and Mary Shelley?

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Link: To Wordsworth

∞ Link: The Haunted House

∞ Link: Casabianca

- How would you describe the style of these poems? Do they remind you of other works you've read so far this year?
- The poem Casabianca, with its tragic pathos, was a poem that almost took on a life of its own upon publication, being often imitated and (later on) parodied. What do you think it was about this poem that made it so popular?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

Lightning Dreamer

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 19

Frankenstein

📄 Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's state of mind after Justine's death from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.65-73 "I spent the following day" - "among some straw, and fell asleep."

- What is Victor's relationship to nature in this section? If you have read Percy Shelley's poem "Mont Blanc," do you see any similarities?
- What are your first impressions of hearing the creature speak? Did any of it surprise you?
- The creature declares "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend" (69). If you have read Paradise Lost, do you recognize any echoes of Milton's epic in today's reading? In the original 1818 version, Shelley



Term 1

included a quotation from *Paradise Lost* as an epigram (Did I request thee, Maker, from my Clay / To mould me Man? Did I solicit thee / From darkness to promote me?)")

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Rabindranath Tagore, cont.

Materials: The Crescent Moon

→ RECAP

What was your favorite poem by Tagore you read last time? What did you like most about it?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.51-54

p. 54 "The Last Bargain"

- Why do you think the child chooses the child instead of the king, the old man, or the fair maiden?
- What do you think the speaker discovers about freedom by the end of the poem?

Read the other poems one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.

- What images stand out to you the most in today's poems?

→ LISTEN

Tagore's words became the basis for both India's and Bangladesh's national anthems. You can listen to them here with an English translation.

∞ Music Link: Jana Gana Mana - India National Anthem English lyrics

∞ Music Link: "Amar Shonar Bangla" - Bangladesh National Anthem Bangla & English lyrics

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 20

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 19

Sonnets VII and X

→ OBSERVE (ORALLY OR IN WRITING)

- What is the rhyme scheme of Sonnets VII and X? Note: think about the way the last two lines in Sonnet X might sound in a Shakespearean British accent.
- Count the syllables in each line of both sonnets and listen to the rhythm of the poems. What do you think the meter is? (answers in the Teacher Note in the next lesson)
- Based on what you know of Shakespearean & Petrarchan sonnets, which form would you say each of Donne's sonnets aligns with more closely? Why? Consider the rhyme scheme, the larger structure (octave+sestet versus three quatrains + couplet), and the content of the poem (where does the turn or "volta" happen in the poem's argument or theme?).

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 20

Sonnet XIV

→ INTRO

Sonnet XIV is one of Donne's most famous sonnets. We're going to spend a bit more time with it today. First, read the poem aloud and narrate, telling what you remember and notice about the images, meaning, or anything else about the poem. Then use the discussion activities to dive deeper.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE
Notes/Answers for Lesson 19

Sonnet VII rhyme scheme:
abbaabbacdcddee. The meter is pretty consistently iambic pentameter (typical for sonnets).
Sonnet X rhyme scheme:
abbaabbacdcddee (the meter is mostly iambic pentameter with some inconsistencies, but it's hard to hear it all because we



Term 1

∞ Article Link: Donne's Holy Sonnets Sonnet XIV • Look at the "formal features" of the poem. What is the rhyme scheme, meter, or structure (Shakespearean or Petrarchan)? • Why might someone argue the sonnet is Shakespearean in structure? What is the evidence for a Petrarchan structure? • What kinds of images or comparisons does Donne use in the poem? What do you think of them? • Notice how Donne breaks the normal flow of a sonnet's iambic pentameter rhythm in the first four lines. Can you hear the "knocking" that Donne creates with the sounds of the words themselves in the lines "knock, breath, shine," and "break, blowe, burn"? Master poets often break the "rules" of a poetic form to add to their poem's effect and meaning. Whenever something is "wrong" in a poem or a book by a skilled writer, it is an invitation to ponder why, most likely, the rule was broken to show the sense of the words visually or acoustically. • What do you think of the poem's overall effect and ideas?	don't pronounce or stress words quite the same as Donne did.
WEEK 10 📅 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10	
WEEK 11 📅 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11 <i>Thomas Carlyle</i> 📖 Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls → RECAP What do you recall about the life and work of Felicia Hemans from last week? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.LXXXII "Carlyle - The Sage of Chelsea" • Marshall writes that Carlyle "was a great historian, but in the history he gives us not dead facts, but living, breathing men and women. His pages are as full of color and of life as the pages of Shakespeare." What history books have you read that could be described that way? Why is it such a praiseworthy feature of history writing? • What do you notice about Carlyle's style in the passages quoted in today's reading?	• COMPOSITION - Descriptive Write a character sketch of Thomas Carlyle based on Marshall's chapter.
WEEK 11 📅 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21 <i>Catch-up</i>	
WEEK 11 📅 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 21 <i>Frankenstein</i> 📖 Materials: Frankenstein → RECAP What do you recall about Victor's response to his creation from your reading last week? → READ & NARRATE p.73-81 "It was noon when I awoke" - "anticipations of joy." • How does the creature describe first experiencing consciousness? What are his first few days like? • Why is the creature so adamant in learning language? What does he think it will do for him?	
WEEK 11 📅 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22 <i>Tagore - Fireflies</i>	



Term 1

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 22

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 21

Serious Sonnets?

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Are you tired of sonnets? Sonnets are dense "little songs," packed with word-pictures that require us to pause and ponder. As you've seen, they are often written in praise of something or someone and can focus on weighty topics like aging, death, and love for God. And they've been around for hundreds of years now, so sometimes the words themselves are hard to understand! Maybe sonnets are your new favorite type of poem. But if they're not, hopefully you're gaining a little more appreciation for how complex they are and how much thought and talent went into each of them! Today, take a break from some of the harder, older sonnets we've been reading and enjoy more recent ones (some with lighter topics, too!).

→ READ & DISCUSS

Pick 2-3 to read and discuss.

p.61 "Composed Upon Westminster Bridge"

p.62 "Ozymandias"

p.65 "From the Dark Tower"

p.67-68 "A Game of Chess"

∞ Article Link: Funny Sonnets (read #1)

∞ Article Link: Poetry

→ DISCUSS

Sonnets are "little songs" and often love poems or poems in praise of a person, God, or something else. And they often present some sort of struggle or problem, and the resolution (remember the "volta" or turn?). If you were going to write a sonnet, what would it be about?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Notes/answers for lesson 20

The rhyming couplet at the end of the sonnet aligns with a typical Shakespearean structure, but the overall rhyme scheme and the shift in thought in the final six lines (notice how the sestet begins a new sentence and starts with the contrasting conjunction, "Yet.") align with a Petrarchan structure.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 22

Writing a Sonnet

Materials: your reference guide

→ WRITE

Begin writing your own sonnet. Keep your reference guide on hand. Here are a few tips to get started:

1. Choose a topic. Perhaps something from a book or something you've experienced. Funny or serious.
2. After you've chosen your topic, think of some different ways to describe it. You might write down "[your topic] is like ____" and try to fill in the blank to get your creative juices flowing.
3. Read and then write a few lines of iambic pentameter to get the rhythm in your head (you can write gibberish - the point is just to get the flow in your mind).
4. Now start putting it all together and write your sonnet. You may want to write a full 14 lines and then go back and change some of the words to get the meter right, adjust a metaphor, etc.

★ STUDENT NOTE

You may choose to continue working on their sonnet during composition time this week or just spend the lesson time working on it. The goal is not to have a finished "product" but to engage the sonnet form experientially and seek to communicate your own ideas through it.

WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
History of Lit. Readings

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Exam

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Frankenstein

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24

Exam

WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Narrative of the Life of Frederick Douglass

OR
Up from Slavery
Souls of Black Folks

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

Ralph Waldo Emerson

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

For the next few weeks, we will meet a selection of American writers and poets who were active in the mid-to-late nineteenth century, around the years 1840-1876. As an introduction, Long has a helpful overview of the characteristics of the literature written during this period.

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF p.#-# "We have noted the significant fact" - "consider an age of poetry."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Biography of Ralph Waldo Emerson

- Do you recognize some of the names of writer who influenced Emerson and who admired him in turn?

2. Spend some time exploring poems written by Emerson, or read excerpts from his famous essay "Self-Reliance" (you probably won't have time to read the whole thing during this lesson time, but you could come back to it later).

∞ Link: Poems by Emerson

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF #-#

- What does non-conformity mean to Emerson? How does he describe it?
- What does Emerson mean by "Trust thyself: every heart vibrates to that iron string"?
- How would you describe Emerson's language and imagery in "Self-Reliance"? What does it remind you of?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

• **IMPORTANT DATES**
Virgil (70BC - 19BC)

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 25

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the Creature's narrative of his first days from your reading last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.81-89 "I now hasten" - "plan of future maintenance."

- Describe the De Lancey family. Do they remind you of other stories you have heard in this narrative so far?
- How do the De Lanceys serve as a foster family and a virtuous example to follow for the Creature, even as they are unaware of his presence?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 26

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ INTRO

The modernist writer Virginia Woolf once praised George Eliot's *Middlemarch* as "one of the few English novels written for grown-up people," and this suggestion of sophistication, psychological depth, and a moral imagination could equally apply to the next novel you will read in this course, *Silas Marner*. George Eliot, the pen name for Mary Ann Evans, described the novel to her publisher as "a sort of legendary tale" to which she decided to give "a more realistic treatment." As you read, look for how these strands of fairy tale or legend interweave with a realistic depiction of nineteenth-century English village life.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.5-13 "In the days when the spinning-wheels" - "for I have been nowhere else."

- How would you describe the setting of Raveloe?
- What are your first impressions of Silas Marner? How does your first impression of him change as you read about his life fifteen years earlier in Lantern Hill?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 25

Introducing Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Storytelling is common in every culture, and before the invention of the printing press, songs, stories, and fables were passed on orally from culture to culture and through the generations. As they traveled, storytellers developed their versions of the tale, adding or adjusting the narrative, the tune, or the verses of the song. The ballad is one form of storytelling with a long tradition, and it became a particular poetic form in English.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.73-78 "The Ballad At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context"

- Do you know any ballads or ballad-like poems/songs (new or old)? Name them and tell why they fit into the ballad genre as described in your book.

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Learn more about the history of ballads in North America.

∞ **Article Link:** LOC Ballads

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 26

Reading Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.78-83 "The Cherry-tree Carol (early 1400s)," "Sir Patrick Spens," "The Wife of Usher's Well," and "My Boy Willie"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Listen to a different version of the *Wife of Usher's Well*.

∞ **Article Link:** The Wife of Usher's Well

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13



Term 2

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

Henry David Thoreau

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What stood out most to you reading about Emerson last week?

→ INTRO

Another Transcendentalist writer who was strongly influenced by Emerson was Henry David Thoreau. As you read today, see if you recognize similar themes and concepts from what you read last week.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. ∞ Article Link: Biography of Henry David Thoreau

2. "Solitude" from *Walden*

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF #-#

- How does Thoreau differentiate between being alone and loneliness? Why, according to him, can people be lonely even when they are with others?
- What does this reading tell us about how Thoreau relates to nature?
- Which aspects of Thoreau's views on solitude are most relevant today? Do you think that modern society still values solitude? What has perhaps made it harder to be alone in the way Thoreau describes?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 27

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the De Lacey family from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.89-97 "Such were the events" - "unperceived to my hovel."

- How does the Creature interpret his own life through the reading he does?
- From Karen Swallow Prior: "Do you fault the De Laceys for their reaction to the creature? Why or why not?"

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 28

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What are your first impressions of the novel and Eliot's writing style based on what you read last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.13-20 "The search was made" - "Old Master Marner."

- How would you describe the religious community Silas is a part of in Raveloe?



Term 2

- What details does Eliot include to emphasize the injustice of what happens to Silas? How does he respond to what happens to him?
- What has his life been like in the fifteen years since he arrived in Raveloe?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 27

Historical Ballads

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Listen to a few more ballads. Although not all folk songs are ballads, older ballads almost always are folk songs (newer ballads were often composed as poems rather than songs). Listen to 3-4.

- ∞ Video Link: The Water of Tyne (1364)
- ∞ Video Link: There Were Three Ravens (published 1611)
- ∞ Video Link: Corpus Christi Carol (early 1500s)
- ∞ Video Link: Frog Went a Courting (first mentioned in 1548, though this version has evolved from then)
- ∞ Video Link: Scarborough Fair (mid 1600s)

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 28

Reflecting on Ballads

📄 Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ REFLECT

Orally or in writing, reflect for about 10 minutes on the ballads from the last two lessons (you may want to reread or rewatch a few). What are the similarities and differences you notice? If you were an alien who knew nothing about the world and all you had were these ballads, what would you think about our world? Describe it to a fellow alien.

→ CREATE

Add a "Ballad-at-a-Glance" section to your reference guide. Refer to p.73.

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

Henry David Thoreau, cont.

📄 Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ RECAP

What stood out most to you reading about Thoreau last week?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Today we will read another chapter from Thoreau's *Walden*. Read as much of it as you can in 20 minutes - if interested, you can always finish it another time. As you read, think about the care Thoreau takes with observation and attention to the natural world around you. How does it compare to other nature studies you have read in the past?

"Spring" from *Walden*

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF #-#

- What aspects of nature become symbolic to Thoreau? What do they represent to him?
- What message about life and renewal do you think Thoreau most wants readers to take from "Spring"?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 29

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Creature's conversation with De Lacey from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.97-105 "Cursed, cursed creator!" - "do not deny me my request!"

- How is the Creature's rescue of the drowning girl and her guardian's shooting of him a pivotal turning point in his narrative?
- What do you think Victor's response will be to the Creature's request?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 30

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What are your first impressions of the novel and Eliot's writing style based on what you read last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.20-30 "This is the history" - "fall on my legs."

- Why do you think Silas has an evening ritual of sorting and counting his money each night? What does the gold mean to him?
- How are members of the Cass family contrasted with Silas? What is the effect of contrasting a poor weaver counting his fortune with a Squire's family experiencing money problems?
- What can you tell about the brother's relationship based on the way they speak to each other? How does Godfrey's secret create a power imbalance?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 29

Recent Ballads

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

Enjoy these more recent ballads. Notice how the content is similar and/or different from the older ballads.

p.88-90 "Peter and John"

p.92-94 "Tale of Custard the Dragon"

p.94-98 "Riverbend Blues" and "Ballad of John Cable and Three Gentlemen"

∞ Video Link: Wreck of the Edmund Fitzgerald

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 30

Writing a Ballad

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Write your own ballad and read (or sing!) it to someone.

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15



Term 2

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

Walt Whitman

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

When Ralph Waldo Emerson first read Walt Whitman's collection *Leaves of Grass*, he wrote the following in a letter: "I find it the most extraordinary piece of wit and wisdom that America has yet contributed. I am very happy in reading it, as great power makes us happy. [. . .] I greet you at the beginning of a great career, which yet must have had a long foreground somewhere, for such a start. I rubbed my eyes a little, to see if this sunbeam were no illusion; but the solid sense of the book is a sober certainty. It has the best merits, namely, of fortifying and encouraging."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Whitman's Biography

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF #-#

- Which excerpts stood out to you the most? Which images were most striking or unusual?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Walt Whitman Revolutionised American Poetry

→ IF YOU HAVE EXTRA TIME, YOU CAN LOOK UP AND READ SOME OF THE POEMS CITED IN TODAY'S READING, ALTHOUGH YOU WILL HAVE A CHANCE TO READ SOME OF WHITMAN'S POETRY THIS WEEK IN THE POETRY READING COURSE.

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 31

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Creature's final request to Victor from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.105-112 "I was moved" - "towns occupy the scene."

- Why does Victor's response to the monster vacillate between sympathy and disgust?
- From Karen Swallow Prior: "Structurally, Victor is pressed to make a mate for the creature and to marry Elizabeth at the same point in time. What is the significance as well as the effect of these two events coinciding in Victor's life?"

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 32

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What did you learn about the relationship between the Cass brothers from what you read last week?



Term 2

→ READ & NARRATE

p.30-38 "With that, Dunstan slammed the door" - "Marner was not there."

- Can you make any predictions about Godfrey's future based on what you learn about him and his choices in today's reading?
- Eliot continuously places her characters into situations where they are given a clear moral choice to make. What choice does Dunstan face at the end of today's reading? What do you think he will do?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 31

Blank Verse

📄 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.101-105 "Blank Verse At-a-Glance," "The History of the Form," "The Contemporary Context," and Henry Howard's excerpt from the Aeneid.

- Read Henry Howard's lines aloud (assume they are iambic and read the stresses that way).

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 32

Older Examples of Blank Verse

📄 Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.105-110 "What is beauty" - "of the whole"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Look for examples of blank verse in Shakespeare's plays!

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Emily Dickinson

📄 Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

You may have read or heard Emily Dickinson's poetry before since many of her poems are anthologized for children, including "Hope is a Thing with Feathers" and "A Bird Came Down the Walk." However, behind their simplicity is often an enigmatic deeper meaning. Today we will learn more about her life and work.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Great Women Authors: Emily Dickinson
∞ Link: History of Lit PDF

- What were some of the major themes of Dickinson's work? How did her unconventional life influence her writing?

2. The Creative Years - a closer look at Dickinson correspondence with Higginson.
∞ Link: History of Lit PDF

You can read two of the more famous letters at the links below:

- ∞ Link: Dickinson Letter 260
- ∞ Link: Dickinson Letter 330

→ VIEW

- ∞ Video Link: Finding Emily Dickinson in the power of her poetry

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33



Term 2

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 33

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's return home from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.112-120 "We travelled at the time" - "sicken in my bosom."

- How are descriptions of nature and travel connected with Victor's internal state of mind in this section?
- What role does Clerval play in the story?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 34

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

Where did we leave Dunstan Cass at the end of last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.38-45 "Nothing at that moment" - "that called for beer."

- Even though we know what has happened, how does Eliot's description of Silas's actions in Chapter 5 build suspense?
- What is the significance of the fact that the loss of his gold requires Silas to return to the society of other people by going to the Rainbow? What does this say about loneliness, isolation, and the need for human connection?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 33

More Recent Blank Verse

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.110-118 "Ulysses" - "Stanzas in Bloomsbury"

• COMPOSITION

Write a narration (or pick a previous narration to rewrite) in blank verse.

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 34

Heroic Couplet

Materials: The Making of a Poem, reference guide

→ CREATE

Add an "at-a-glance" section for Blank Verse to your reference guide.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.121-123 "The Heroic Couplet At-a-Glance," and "The History of the Form"

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

Catch-Up Day

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 35

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's travels with Clerval from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.120-127 "I sat one evening" - "to my recollection."

- Why does Victor ultimately decide to abandon his project and deny the Creature's request?
- How does Victor interpret the Creature's threat?
- What do you think is about to happen?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 36

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about how Silas reacted to the loss of his gold?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.46-54 "The conversation, which was at a high pitch" - "conditions of ghostly phenomena."

- You may not understand all the backs-and-forths in this tavern conversation, but what sense do you get of provincial life in a nineteenth-century English village? What concerns do they have?
- How does Eliot's mimicking of individuals' style of speech reveal details about their characters?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 35

Chaucer: The Beginning of Heroic Couplets

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Canterbury Tales, General Prologue

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 36

Reading Heroic Couplets

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.123-127 "from the Description of Cooke-ham" - "from the Vanity of Human Wishes"



Term 2

- Use heroic couplets to narrate your impressions of one of the poems you read.

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

The Victorian Period

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

The close of the Romantic Period is commonly marked by the death of Sir Walter Scott in 1832, and the remainder of the nineteenth-century in British Literature is referred to as the Victorian Period, named for Queen Victoria who reigned from 1837-1901. Literature written during this period often focused on social issues, the changes wrought by the Industrial Revolution, effects of new discoveries in science and a concern for morality. This was also the period that saw the rise in popularity of the novel.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: History of Lit PDF "The Victorian Period" p. #-#

- Where do you see elements and concerns of the Victorian Period still present in our culture today?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 37

The Aeneid - Introduction

Materials: The Aeneid

→ INTRO

What do you know about an "epic" – what are the connotations of the word more broadly, and what do you know about epics in literature?

Name any you have read and what you remember about epic conventions.

Virgil's Aeneid is an epic that owes much to Homer's two books, The Iliad and the Odyssey, which you may have already read in part or as a retelling. Chronologically, the story of The Aeneid picks up where the Iliad left off - with the fall of Troy - but Virgil lived 700-800 years after Homer, in a very different world. During Virgil's lifetime, the Roman Republic was coming to an - at times violent - end, and amid this uncertainty, Virgil looked backwards and chose the founding of Rome as his epic subject: following the Trojan Aeneas from the destruction of Troy to the founding of a new city.

C.S. Lewis, in his Preface to Paradise Lost, saw epics like the Iliad, the Odyssey, and Beowulf, as "Primary Epics": they are works written down after a long tradition of oral storytelling, and tell the story of heroic deeds in order that such deeds may be remembered. They are myth-making stories, far more concerned with the life of one hero - Achilles, Odysseus, Beowulf - than with the wider historical context.

However, Lewis argues that something new happens with Virgil, and the Aeneid is the earliest example of a "Secondary Epic": "one of the most important revolutions in the history of poetry." In The Aeneid, Lewis writes, Virgil "decides to take one single national legend and treat it in such a way that we feel the vaster theme to be somehow implicit in it. He has to tell a comparatively short story and give us the illusion of having lived through a great space of time. He has to deal with a limited number of personages and make us feel as if national, or almost cosmic, issues are involved. He must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

• COMPOSITION -

Compare/Contrast

Compare The Aeneid's opening Invocation to the Muse (lines 1-13) to the openings of The Iliad and The Odyssey.

∞ PDF Link: Iliad Opening Lines

∞ PDF Link: Odyssey Opening Lines

- How is Virgil both imitating Homer and also doing something very new?



Term 2

1. This helpful introduction to the Aeneid should give you a clear overview of the context of the epic and the general plot before we dive into the poem itself. You can read some of it today (skip the three exercises), or refer to it as you are reading the poem if you feel stuck.

∞ Link: Introduction to Virgil's Aeneid

2. Book 1, lines 1-96 "Wars and a man I sing" - "King of Cloudbursts."

- Today is a short reading to allow you time to look up characters in the Pronouncing Glossary (p.424-484) and begin to make a character list, if you would find that helpful.

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 37

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the Creature's confrontation and threat to Victor from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.128-135 "I was soon introduced" - "and I wept bitterly."

- How does Victor's story at this point parallel Justine's? How is it different?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 38

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading? How does Virgil open his epic?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 97-367 "With such thanks" - "the men of Troy."

- What have you learned so far about the Aeneas's character? Why do you think he "assumes a look of hope / and keeps his anguish buried in his heart?"

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 38

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the conversation at the Rainbow from last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.55-62 "Yet the next moment" - "severe public duties."

- How do the various characters at the tavern react to Silas's news? Why is the robbery such a point of local interest and gossip?
- Are you noticing Silas's behavior beginning to change?

- **COMPOSITION - Point of View**
Chose one of the characters from the tavern (or invent you own), and retell the entrance of Silas Marner at the Rainbow from that individual's point of view.



Term 2

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 37

More Heroic Couplets

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.127-130 "To S.M" - "From an Essay on Criticism"

→ CREATE

Add an at-a-glance page on heroic couplets to your reference guide.

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 38

The Stanza

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

What comes to your mind at the word "stanza"?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.136-142 "The Stanza At-a-Glance," - "from The Faerie Queene" (be sure to read Chaucer and Spenser's poems aloud)

- Why do the authors argue that the stanza is the "opposite of blank verse"?

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

Charles Dickens

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

You have likely already read a novel or two by Charles Dickens, but even if you haven't, characters like Scrooge and Oliver Twist, or lines such as "It was the best of times, it was the worst of times," have become familiar adages. Today you will learn more about his life and work

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXIV "Dickens - Smiles and Tears"

- What do you notice about Dickens style in the passages quoted here?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 39

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 367-595 "But Aeneas, duty-bound" - "who dares to battle men."

- What have you learned so far about the gods? How do they interact with mortals?
- Why do you think Venus comes to Aeneas in disguise?
- Why does Aeneas have such an emotional reaction when he sees images of the Trojan War displayed in Carthage?

→ CLOSE READING

- COMPOSITION - Descriptive
Try writing your own epic simile.
It can be in prose or verse.



Term 2

- 517-528: This is an example of an epic simile, which is an extended comparison. Here Virgil compares workmen making a theater to the labor of bees. Why is this a striking comparison?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 39

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's time in prison from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.135-143 "Ever since my recovery" - "cling to me forever."

- From Karen Swallow Prior: "Trace the role of Victor's father throughout this point in the novel. At one point, Victor describes him as "indulgent." Is this an accurate description? Does this turn out to be a helpful or destructive quality?"
- How does Victor feel as his wedding approaches? Do you recognize any warning signs or foreshadowing?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 40

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 1, lines 596-908 "And now / As Trojan Aeneas" - "and seas on earth."

- Why does Venus send Cupid disguised as Ascanius? Do you think Venus is trying to protect Aeneas, manipulate the situation, or both?
- Is Dido responsible for her eventual feelings for Aeneas if the gods interfere so heavily? What early signs in this passage hint that the relationship between Dido and Aeneas may become tragic?
- How much free will do mortals seem to have in the epic? This is a question to come back to as you read further.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Aeneas's son is called both Ascanius and Iulus.

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 40

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall from last week's reading?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.62-70 "Some disappointment was felt" - "do a dishonest trick, sir."

- What does today's reading reveal about the character of Godfrey Cass? Do you find him to be morally weak or justified in hiding his secret?
- In what ways are Godfrey Cass and Silas Marner reflections and contrasts of each other?



Term 2

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 39

George Herbert

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

George Herbert was a master of using stanzas in a variety of different ways. He was also a sonneteer and a poet-priest, like John Donne, in the late 16th and early 17th century.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.143 "Easter Wings"

∞ Article Link: The Altar

∞ Article Link: The Pulley

∞ Article Link: Prayer (I)

∞ Article Link: Redemption

- Consider how George Herbert uses poetic features to show an aspect of the poem's meaning. For instance, in the poem "The Pulley", look at how the line, "rest in the bottom lay," is at the bottom of the stanza. What other examples can you find?
- Where is the "turn" or volta in Herbert's sonnet "Prayer (I)"?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Pay attention to the stanzas you're reading in Fierce Wars and Faithful Loves in your Poetry Reading lessons!

Also, consider incorporating some of Herbert's poetry into your devotional life.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 40

Reading Stanzas

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.143-147 "The Tyger," - "A Quoi Bon Dire"

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 41

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 1-255 "Silence. All fell hushed" - "nor all the thousand ships."

- Have you heard the phrase "beware the Greeks bearing gifts" before? Why do you think it has become an adage?
- Why do you think Virgil chooses to recount the fall of Troy through the narrative of Aeneas rather than directly? How do you see Aeneas's emotion shaping the story he tells?
- What role does Sinon play in this section?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 41

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's state of mind as his wedding approaches from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE



Term 2

p.143-150 "It was eight o'clock" - "but he escaped, I know not how."

- How is Elizabeth's death another turning point for Victor? What other victims are there of this murder?
- What happens when Victor finally tells his story to someone?
- Has Victor finally become like his creation at this point in the story, now that he is all alone in the world?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 42

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 42

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What insights did you get last week into the character of Godfrey Cass?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.70-79 "Where's Dunsey, then?" - "it's a long while since."

- Godfrey hopes for "some unforeseen turn of fortune, some favorable chance which would save him from unpleasant consequences" - what is the role of chance/fate/fortune in the character's lives thus far?
- How has Silas's life become upended with the loss of his gold? How does he respond when the villagers begin to reach out to him. What does this tell us about his character?

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 41

More Stanzas

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.148-149 "The Tropics in New York" and "Night Song at Amalfi"

p.150-151 "Those Winter Sundays" and "Yes"

★ TEACHER NOTE
Sensitive Word in "Yes."

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 42

Materials: The Making of a Poem and your reference guide

→ CREATE

Add a stanza-at-a-glance section to your reference guide.

→ WRITE

Look/think back over the different types of stanzas you've seen. Then write a poem about something that you read about in school or experienced in life, choosing a particular way of using stanzas that will add meaning to your poem. Add a note at the end of your poem explaining why you used stanzas the way you did.

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 43

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 256-501 "But a new portent" - "they know so well."

- Can you find epic similes in this section? Why do you think there are so many of them in battle scenes?
- What is the significance of Aeneas dreaming of Hector's ghost? What message does Hector have for Aeneas?
- Why does Aeneas keep fighting even once it is clear that Troy is lost?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 43

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Victor's time in prison from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.150-158 "Amidst the wilds of Tartary and Russia" - "and I may die."

- After hearing his whole story, what is Walton's assessment of Victor? How has his story affected those who heard it?
- Why does Victor reject Walton's offering of friendship?
- How do you think the story will end?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 44

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 44

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.79-86 "After receiving such an answer" - "past experience had become dim."

- Describe the character of Dolly Winthrop. How does she try to help Silas? What does she tell him about church, and how is her description different from the religious community of Lantern Hill?
- Eliot says of Silas "the fountains of human love and of faith in a divine love had not yet been unlocked." How did he get to be this way? Do see any foreshadowing in this sentence?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 43

Meter At-a-Glance

Materials: The Making of a Poem, reference guide (opt.)

→ READ

p.159-160 "Types of Meter" and "the Character of Different Types of Meter"

→ DISCUSS

The overview of the meter is a bit dense, so let's make it more concrete.

- Look back over poems in these lessons and jot down a few other poems or songs you know. Make a list with examples of accentual metered poems, syllabic metered poems, and accentual-syllabic metered poems.
- You may want to turn this section into a new part of your reference guide

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

If you find it hard to think of examples for the lesson assignment, here are a few to get you started.

Accentual: Beowulf; Ba Ba Black Sheep

Syllabic: Think of Haikus you've read

Accentual-syllabic: Many sonnets



Term 2

as well.

- Why might a poet choose to use one form versus another?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 44

Materials: The Making of a Poem, your reference guide

→ READ

p.160

→ NARRATE

- Write your own examples for each of the "feet" described.
- These definitions lend themselves to visual representation. Create an infographic (by hand or digitally) describing the different "feet" in poetry to add to your reference guide.

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22

WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23

Alfred Lord Tennyson

Materials: English Literature for Boys & Girls

→ INTRO

William Long writes of Tennyson: "Though the Victorian age is notable for the quality and variety of its prose works, its dominant figure for years was the poet Tennyson. He alone, of all that brilliant group of Victorian writers, seemed to speak not for himself but for his age and nation; and the nation, grown weary of Byronic rebellion, and finding its joy or sorrow expressed with almost faultless taste by one whose life was noble, gave to Tennyson a whole-souled allegiance such as few poets have ever won." And he goes on, "There is a wide variety in Tennyson's work : legend, romance, battle song, nature, classic and medieval heroes, problems of society, questions of science, the answer of faith,— almost everything that could interest an alert Victorian mind found some expression in his poetry." Today you will learn more about his life and work, and will read his well-known poem Ulysses, if you are taking the Poetry Reading course.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.LXXXV "Tennyson - The Poet of Friendship"

- What images and excerpts included in this chapter stood out to you?

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 45

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 501-725 "But oh / how wrong to rely" - "bow to my commands."

- Why is Priam's death such a turning point in the fall of Troy? What details does Virgil include to make it particularly tragic?
- What is Aeneas's reaction to Priam's death?
- Why does Venus appear at that moment, and what is her message to Aeneas?



Term 2

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 45

Frankenstein

Materials: Frankenstein

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Walton's letter to his sister from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.158-166 "I write to you, encompassed by peril" - "lost in darkness and distance."

- Why do you think Shelley includes the mutiny plot and the decision to return to England at the end of the novel?
- How does Walton react to the Creature? How does he describe him?
- What do you think of the final image in the novel of the Creature "lost in darkness and distance." Is the story resolved? Or are there elements of the narrative that feel unfinished?
- Overall, what are your reflections on the novel?

• COMPOSITION - Descriptive

The narrative that frames Frankenstein - letters from Walton to his sister - takes place in the arctic on a vessel bound for scientific exploration. From other reading you have done this year, what do you think is the significance for the arctic as the setting of the final confrontation between creator and creation? How does it connect to other natural environments described in the novel?

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 46

Tennyson

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 46

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the character of Dolly from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.86-94 "But in Raveloe" - "will like to go down."

- How do the Christmas party preparations at the Red House contrast to the scenes just preceding of Silas's own Christmas?
- Give a brief character sketch of Nancy's sister Priscilla.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 45

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Refer to p.160 and write a few lines about something from your books or life, and use iambs as the main meter throughout the poem. Then write a few lines about the same topic using trochees. How did it change the feel of the poem?

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

You may find it helpful to review examples of iambic and trochaic lines before writing to get the rhythm in your head.

Iambic examples: many sonnets.

Trochaic example: Tyger Tyger by William Blake (p.143), especially the first two lines.

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 46

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Refer to p.160 and write a few lines about something from your books or in your life, and use dactyls as the main meter throughout the poem. Then write a few lines about the same topic using anapests. How did it change the feel of the poem?

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

You may find it helpful to review examples of dactylic and anapestic lines before writing to get the rhythm in your head.

Dactylic example:

∞ **Article Link:** The Charge of the Light Brigade

Anapestic example:

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2	
Bonus idea: If you want to challenge yourself, try adding a spondee into one of your poems as well.	∞ Article Link: The Destruction of Sennacherib
WEEK 11 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23	
WEEK 12 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 47 Exam	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 47 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Frankenstein	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 48 Exam	
WEEK 12 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 48 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Silas Marner	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 47 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Making of a Poem	
WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 48 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: The Making of a Poem	
WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24	



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

Mark Twain

Materials: History of Lit PDF

→ INTRO

You many have already come across Mark Twain and his influence in other literature courses this year. The twentieth-century novelist Ernest Hemingway claimed that "All modern American literature comes from one book by Mark Twain called Huckleberry Finn." What do you already know about Mark Twain and what have you read?

Today we will learn more about Twain through his life, his influence worldwide, and through reading a short story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Twain's Biography

∞ Article Link: Biography - Mark Twain

∞ Video Link: Mark Twain - Writer

2. Twain's Influence

∞ Article Link: Mark Twain and World Literature

• Which examples cited in this article were most surprising to you?

3. "Luck" by Mark Twain

∞ Link: History of Lit PDF #-#

• Where do you find irony in this story? Was it what you expected it would be?

• How reliable is the clergyman as a storyteller?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 49

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 2, lines 725-998 "There / yes, where you see" - "headed toward the mountains."

• Venus shows Aeneas the actions of the gods in the fall of Troy - what does this say about fate and human action?

• Is Aeneas at fault for what happens to Creusa? Why or why not? How is your answer affected by her ghost's final speech?

• Book II ends with Aeneas carrying his father and leading his son. How is this symbolic for the past of Troy and the future of Rome?

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 49

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 50

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

Book 3 begins with Aeneas and his companions escaping from the destruction of Troy and beginning their arduous journey westward to Italy. They encounter several challenges and false starts along the way. Eventually, Aeneas hears that the Trojan Helenus, who has married



Term 3

Hector's widow Andromache, has settled in Buthrotum, and that is where our reading for today resumes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 3, lines 350-592 "Here an incredible story" - "challenge all our children."

- Helenus, son of Priam and a seer, and Andromache are both characters from the Iliad. Why is it significant that Aeneas meets them at this point, and what prophecy does Helenus offer Aeneas?
- How is Buthrotum described? Is it familiar to Aeneas? Why does he choose to move on rather than stay and settle in a "miniature Troy"?
- In this section, does Aeneas seem more like a warrior, a leader, or a pilgrim guided by fate?

→ VIEW

The following map is a helpful guide as you read about Aeneas's journey:
∞ Map Link: Map of the Voyage of Aeneas and the Mythic Origins of Rome

WEEK 1 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 50

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

We left the Lammeter sisters mid-conversation. Do you recall what was happening at the party?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.94-102 "'Sister,' said Nancy" - "very long coat-tails."

- In what ways are characters at the party concerned with status, reputation, and social expectations?
- What does the party reveal about the social structure and values of Raveloe society?

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 49

Shaping Forms

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Stop to narrate after reading each section.

p.165-171 "Overview" "The Elegy-Overview," "Lament for the Makaris"

- Discuss this quote: "If metrical forms are the architecture of poetry, then the shaping forms of ode, elegy, and pastoral are its environment" (p.165)

• TERMINOLOGY

"Timor Mortis conturbat me" is Latin for "The fear of death disturbs me."

WEEK 1 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 50

Reading Elegies

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

Orally or in writing, reflect for about 5 minutes on the role of the poet and poetry today. Is poetry a part of public or popular life? Where and when? What types of poetry do you hear most frequently?

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.171-178 "If Ever Hapless Woman Had a Cause" - "Lycidas"

WEEK 1 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

WEEK 2 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26



Term 3

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 51

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ INTRO

Paul Lawrence Dunbar was one of the first Black Americans to earn a living as a writer and he inspired many other literary giants that would come after him. In fact, "I know why the caged bird sings" (one of the most iconic lines in African American literature and the title of Maya Angelo's autobiography) comes from one of Dunbar's poems. He was the only Black student in his high school, and became friends with Orville Wright and his brother Wilbur (who you may remember as the inventors of the airplane). The Wright brothers owned a printing press and published Dunbar's first writings. While Dunbar only lived to age 33, he has been described as "your favorite poet's favorite poet" due to the impact his large body of work had on future writers. Older students may want to read more about Dunbar in extra helpings.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.103-104 "Author's Note"

p. 1-10 "You never heard of" - "could try again."

- Why do you think the book says "it's almost like two different men wrote those two poems"? What are some of the differences both in form and content?

- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once.

Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Fifth Massachusetts Colored Calvary

• EXTRA HELPING

For more on Paul Laurence Dunbar, you can read his full biography here:

∞ Link: Paul Laurence Dunbar bio

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 51

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 52

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

Book 3 begins with Aeneas and his companions escaping from the destruction of Troy and beginning their arduous journey westward to Italy. They encounter several challenges and false starts along the way. Eventually, Aeneas hears that the Trojan Helenus, who has married Hector's widow Andromache, has settled in Buthrotum, and that is where our reading for today resumes.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 3, lines 350-592 "Here an incredible story" - "challenge all our children."

- Helenus, son of Priam and a seer, and Andromache are both characters from the Iliad. Why is it significant that Aeneas meets them at this point, and what prophecy does Helenus offer Aeneas?

- How is Buthrotum described? Is it familiar to Aeneas? Why does he choose to move on rather than stay and settle in a "miniature Troy"?

- In this section, does Aeneas seem more like a warrior, a leader, or a pilgrim guided by fate?



Term 3

→ VIEW

The following map is a helpful guide as you read about Aeneas's journey:
 ∞ Map Link: Map of the Voyage of Aeneas and the Mythic Origins of Rome

WEEK 2 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 52

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.102-109 "Already Mr. Macey" - "delicate, half-transparent lids."

- How does Nancy Lammeter behave at the party, and what does her behavior reveal about her personality and values?
- Why do you think Eliot set the New Year's party directly before the turning point in the novel?

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 51

Here Follow Some Verses

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ RECAP

Describe an elegy.

→ INTRO

Anne Bradstreet is a famous American poet. She was a master of meter and form. We're spending today on a poem she wrote after her house burned down. Be sure to read the poem aloud.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.178-180 "Here Follows Some Verses"

- Discuss this poem using naturalist Jack Laws' questions: What do you notice about this poem (including formal features)? What does it make you wonder? What does it remind you of? Look up words you don't know. Underline lines that stick out to you. Write questions or reactions.

• COMPOSITION

Rewrite Anne Bradstreet's poem as a one-act play.

WEEK 2 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 52

More Elegies

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.180-190 "Elegy Written in a Country Churchyard" - "In Memory of W.B. Yeats"

- Of what you read today, which poem or poet would you most like to learn more about? Why?

WEEK 2 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

WEEK 3 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27



Term 3

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 53

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul Dunbar's family from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-16 "Little brown baby" - "Come in hyeah, you scamp!"

p.108-110 "Joshua Dunbar" - "for their beauty, as well."

p.17-20 "Matilda Dunbar loved" - "an' say good night."

- Paul Dunbar is acclaimed by literary historians for his innovation and experimentation. Where do you see evidence of that in the poems you are reading?
- Look closely at "When de Co'n Pone's Hot" (p.13-14): can you identify the meter (syllables per line) and a regular rhyme scheme? Is there a pattern? For an even bigger challenge, see if you can identify which syllables in each line are stressed (have more emphasis when you pronounce them). Is this regular, too?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 53

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 54

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ INTRO

After Aeneas leaves Buthrotum, he and his men sail near the land of the Cyclopes and rescue Achaemenides, a Greek who was left behind after Odysseus escaped the Cyclopes Polyphemus in *The Odyssey*. They then reach Sicily, where Aeneas's father dies, presumably of old age (3.818-829). We will pick up the story again with Book 4.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 1-247 "But the Queen" - "piling fuel on his fire."

- How much of what happens in this section is individual choice, and how much is fate controlled by the gods?
- What do you think of Anna's advice?
- Where do you see foreshadowing of tragedy in the way the love story is described?

WEEK 3 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 54

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What did you learn last week about Godfrey's wife in the brief moments she is in the novel?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.109-117 "But where was Silas Marner" - "full story of this night."



Term 3

- What is the significance of Silas mistaking the sleeping child for gold?
- What do you make of the line "at the end of sixteen years every line in the worn face was present to him when he told the full story of this night." What is Eliot hinting will happen to Godfrey's secret?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 53

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

You do not have to read all the poems in this section. Pick ones that interest you most. Notice all the different structures and formal features (meter, rhyme, etc) that poets employ for these elegies.
p.191-206 "The Quaker in Nantucket" - "The Song"

- If you were to write an elegy, what would you write it about?

WEEK 3 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 54

Writing an Elegy

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Start writing your own elegy. Add a note on why you chose the particular "architecture" (meter, rhyme, etc.) for your poem.

WEEK 3 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

WEEK 4 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 55

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul Dunbar's family from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.20-28 "Now, school" - "had made it possible."
p.110-111 "Central High School" - "Ohio Historical Society, Columbus."
p.29-31 "When Paul commenced" - "Who fought for Uncle Sam."

- Why do you think Dunbar chose not to write in dialect when composing "The Colored Soldiers"?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 55

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 56

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the opening of Book 4?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 248-494 "Iarbas - son of an African nymph" - "down upon her

★ TEACHER TIP

Sensitive content: preview the opening of today's reading, Book 4, line 248.



Term 3

bed."

- How does Virgil describe Rumor? What makes Rumor such a powerful force in society and politics?
- What causes Aeneas to decide to leave Carthage?
- Do Dido and Aeneas seem to understand their relationship in the same way when they have their final conversation?
- If you have read the Odyssey, do you see a parallel in Odysseus's journey with Aeneas's time in Carthage?

WEEK 4 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 56

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.117-125 "He turned immediately" - "because she had joy."

- How does Godfrey react when faced with a moral choice?
- What is the significance of Silas's fits? How have they impacted the narrative thus far? Why do you think Eliot would choose to give Silas this affliction?
- How does the presence of the child begin to change Silas?

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 55

The Pastoral

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.207-212 "The Passionate Shepherd to His Love" - "The Garden"

WEEK 4 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 56

Reading Pastorals

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ RECAP

Orally or in writing, describe some of the key themes in a pastoral.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.213- 219 "To My Sister" - "Lying in a Hammock"

WEEK 4 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

WEEK 5 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 57

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Paul's time in school from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-40 "Door after door closed" - "likely just the way it was."

p.111-112 "The Western Association of Writers" - "ghosts and goblins."

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to the poet and author Maya Angelou recite Sympathy.

∞ Video Link: Maya Angelou recites Sympathy



Term 3

- What images in "Sympathy" stood out to you the most? Does it remind you of anything else you've read this year?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
- Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 57

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 58

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 494-653 "But Aeneas / is driven by duty" - "Dido says her prayers."

- How many of Aeneas's choices are his own, and how many are dictated by fate and the gods?
- Why does Dido decide that death is her only option?

WEEK 5 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 58

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do recall about Silas's relationship with the child from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.125-133 "And when the sunshine grew strong" - "a father's duty."

- How does Silas parent Eppie? What decisions does he make that are different than Dolly suggests? What is the result?
- What elements of fairy tale or legend have you noticed in the story thus far?
- What do you think of Godfrey's choices? Would you have had him act differently?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 57

More Pastorals

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.223-226 "Fog" - "Smoke"

p.227-232 "From the Porch" - Tornadoes"

- Orally or in writing, discuss one of the poems you read. What stood out to you? What made you confused, intrigued, and/or shocked?

WEEK 5 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 58

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ INTRO

This last pastoral we'll read is by a more recent poet, Mary Oliver, who



Term 3

has continued celebrating the beauty of nature.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.235 "The Black Walnut Tree"

∞ Article Link: Starlings in Winter

∞ Article Link: Invitation

∞ Article Link: The Summer Day

Would you consider these poems pastorals? Why or why not?

WEEK 5 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

WEEK 6 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 59

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.41-48 "I don't suppose" - "but who could he share them with?"

- Does the language and style of "The Unsung Hero" remind you of anything else you've read? What images stand out to you the most?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 59

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 60

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 4, lines 653-876 "The dead of night" - "dissolved in the winds."

- How are Dido's and Aeneas's actions contrasted with each other's in this section?
- What details does Virgil include that heighten the tragedy of Dido's death?
- Why does Juno send Iris to Dido?

WEEK 6 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 60

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.137-144 "It was a bright autumn Sunday" - "when I was sitting still."



Term 3

- How have the characters changed after sixteen years? Did anything surprise you?

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 59

Writing a Pastoral

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

Begin writing your own pastoral and then read it to someone. Add a note about why you used the "architecture" (meter, rhyme, etc.) that you did.

WEEK 6 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 60

The Ode

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.240-246 "Overview" - "The Fire of Driftwood"

- Discuss how each of the poems you read fits the definition of an ode (or not).

WEEK 6 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

WEEK 7 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 61

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.48-56 "But I don't want you to think" - "how deep you dig."

p.112-113 "It would be a shame" - "border of the United States."

p.57-60 "Chicago was behind Paul" - "nuffin' in de pot."

- Why do you think this poem is called a sermon? What is the message of the sermon?
- What does the author mean when she says "Studying a poem isn't like solving a problem in math"?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 61

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 62

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO



Term 3

In Book 5, Aeneas and the other Trojans leave Carthage and return again to Sicily. There they decide to hold funeral games - including races, boxing, and archery - to honour Aeneas's father Anchises. While the games are going on, the Trojan Women decide to try and burn the ships so that their journey will end there, but Jupiter sends rain to put out the flames. Aeneas is encouraged by the ghost of his father to continue his journey, but those who no longer want to join him are given the option to stay with King Acestes in Sicily.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Book 6, lines 1-248 "So as he speaks in tears" - "into the vatic Sibyl's shrine."

- How is the Sibyl of Cumae both a prophet and a warning figure? What does she reveal to him about his future?
- Why does Aeneas want to go to the Underworld? What does the Sibyl tell him?

WEEK 7 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 62

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the characters sixteen years later from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.144-150 "Dolly was too useful" - "than so much at once."

- How has Dolly helped Silas recover from what was done to him at Lantern Hill?
- Describe the character of Eppie. What kind of young woman has she grown up to be?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 61

Reading Odes

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.248-255 "The Paper Nautilus" - "Perhaps the World Ends Here"

Pick one poem to observe more closely.

- Discuss what you notice about the images, meter, and rhyme.
- Why do you think the authors of the anthology considered it an ode?
- What are some of the ideas you notice in the poem?

WEEK 7 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 62

Perhaps the World Ends Here

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ LISTEN

Let's spend a little more time with an ode you read last week.

Read p.254-255

∞ Video Link: Perhaps the World Ends Here

→ DISCUSS

Reflect on the images in the poem. Why does the "world begin at the kitchen table"? What does the kitchen table symbolize or mean to you?

WEEK 7 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 8 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 63

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.60-66 "It was time for another book" - "in a broken tongue."

p.114 "In the 1800s" - "member of the family."

p.67-69 "I suppose by now" - "you are welcome, welcome."

- The author writes "Seems to me that when he started putting together his second book, Paul must have been listening to his heart and his head both." Which qualities of his poetry do you think come from his heart, and which ones from his head?

- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once.

Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.

Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

• COMPOSITION

How did the hardships of Dunbar's childhood shape him as a writer and a person? Why do you think those same difficulties became a source of strength rather than holding him back?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 63

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 64

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

Our reading picks up today once Aeneas has entered the Underworld and seen a number of people whom he knew.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 6, lines 521-554 "And wandering among them" - "pities her as she passes."

- Why do you think Dido does not speak to Aeneas? Who does he blame for her death?

2. Book 6, lines 786-1039 "Now father Anchises" - "the sterns line the shore."

- What does Aeneas's father Anchises show to him? Why is this a significant turning point halfway through the epic?

WEEK 8 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 64

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do recall about Silas's relationship with grown up Eppie from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.151-158 "While Silas and Eppie" - "vexed him in other ways."



Term 3

- What has happened to Nancy and Godfrey over the past sixteen years? What is their relationship like now?
- What makes Silas a stronger parent to Eppie than Godfrey, despite lacking wealth or social status?

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 63 *Writing an Ode*

→ **WRITE**
Compose your own ode.

WEEK 8 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 64 *Open Forms*

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.259 "Overview"

→ **READ & DISCUSS**

In addition to its identity as an "open form," Prufrock is a wonderful example of how poems require "associative thinking." All poems, but especially some like Prufrock, require you to approach them like a painting. Only after you have observed the whole can you start to think about the ideas and emotions it describes. As you read and listen to the poem, let the words roll over you and let your mind drift with them. Listen to the sounds of the lines, the images described (some of them startling!), and notice the emotions the poem evokes. Do you feel frustrated as you read? Perhaps the poem INTENDS to make you feel frustrated!
p.262 "The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock"

- What images most strike you? What lines are most confusing? If this poem were a color, what color would it be? Why?
- Have you felt any of the emotions the speaker describes? Maybe you, too, have felt like you were "pinned and wriggling on a wall" when someone spoke to you.
- If you were going to draw an illustration to accompany this poem, what would it be?

• **EXTRA HELPINGS**

Listen to the author read his own poem

∞ **Video Link:** The Love Song of J. Alfred Prufrock

• **ILLUSTRATE**

Draw or paint your own illustration of the poem!

WEEK 8 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

WEEK 9 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 65 *Jump Back, Paul*

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ **RECAP**
What do you recall from the last reading?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.69-78 "Majors and Minors" - "a brave man to voice it."
p.114-115 "When Alice's answering letter" - "by Jerome Dowd."

- Why do you think Dunbar chose the tree to recount the story of the murder?
- What are some of the other poems you have read so far by Paul Dunbar that seem to be addressing the racism and inequality described in today's reading?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once.



Term 3

Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 65

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 66

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

We are skipping Book 7 because of time constraints, but in the remaining readings from the Aeneid, you will notice a change of subject matter and style. If the first six books mirror the events of the Odyssey, the final six books mirror the events of the Iliad, with its martial theme.

In Book 7, Aeneas and the Trojans finally arrived in the Italian lands they have been promised by fate. They meet King Latinus, who believes fate has chosen Aeneas to marry his daughter Lavinia, but Juno's fury sets in motion a chain of events that destroys this early peace and sets the stage for war.

Our reading today picks up partway through Book 8, after Aeneas has made an alliance with King Evander, whose son Pallas leads an army to give Aeneas assistance.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 8, lines 717-858 "But the goddess Venus" - "all his children's children."

- What images does Vulcan forge onto the surface of the shield? Why are they significant at this point in the epic? Does this section help you understand what Lewis means when he argues that Virgil "must locate his action in a legendary past and yet make us feel the present, and the intervening centuries, already foreshadowed"?
- This section is another example of ekphrasis: a poetic description of a work of art. How does Virgil draw attention to the sculptural features of the shield? Could this shield actual exist as described, or is it mythical?

WEEK 9 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 66

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about Nancy and Godfrey's marriage from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.158-164 "This possibility was Nancy's" - "quiet at the stone pits."

- What does the chapter suggest about responsibility and timing? Can some mistakes be corrected too late?
- What does Dunstan's fate suggest about Eliot's moral vision in the novel?
- How does Nancy's reaction to Godfrey's confession reveal her moral character?

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 65

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.266 "I, Too"

p.268 "Spring and All"

∞ Article Link: From an Atlas of the Difficult World

∞ Article Link: Caged Bird

WEEK 9 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 66

Write your own open-form poem

→ WRITE

You get to pick the form! Write a poem about something from your books and/or life. Add a note explaining why you picked the structure/meter (or lack of it) that you did.

WEEK 9 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

WEEK 10 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 67

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.79-90 "There, now, I guess" - "telling those stories too."

p.116 "Will Marion Cook" - "easy and effortless."

- Why do you think Paul continued to write dialect poems? And why do they still remain important to read today, over a hundred years later?
- Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence. Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

- **COMPOSITION** - Letter
Write a letter from Paul to his mother describing his time in England.

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 67

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 68

The Aeneid, cont.

Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 9, Turnus - king of the Rutulians, ally to King Latinus, and suitor of Lavinia - wages a surprise nighttime attack on the Trojans while Aeneas is away. This book describes the ensuing battle, emphasizing the courage and loyalty of the Trojans, and the human cost of war.

Today's reading picks up in the middle of a battle, and contains many vivid descriptions of violence.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 10, lines 471-774 "Suddenly Pallas runs Rhoeteus through" - "scatter



Term 3

all his triumph."

- Compare Pallas and Turnus: what are their similarities and differences as warriors.
- How does this passage illustrate the human cost of war? One place to look is in the epic similes.
- How are the gods involved in the outcome?

WEEK 10 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 68

Silas Marner

Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the discovery at the Stone-pits from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.165-173 "Between eight and nine o'clock" - "unable to say more."

- Eliot describes Silas's face as showing a "sort of transfiguration, as he sat in his armchair and looked at Eppie" after the discovery of his gold. What other transfigurations have occurred in the novel?
- How does the reveal of Eppie's parentage to her by the Casses touch on some of Eliot's broader themes in the novel?
- What role does free choice play in Eppie's decision about her future?

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 67

Your Reference Guide

→ REVISE

Look back over the poetic architecture and environments you've studied over the year. Spend a few minutes looking over your reference book as well. Is there anything you want to add or revise?

→ READ

Reread a few of your favorite poems from over the year.

WEEK 10 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 68

Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ WRITE

- Describe each poetic form in one sentence covered this year, without actually using its name. Write, record, or use voice-to-text to write your answers and edit as desired. You will refer to these in the next lesson.
- Now, describe each poetic form with one word.

★ TEACHER/STUDENT TIP

You will need a classmate, friend, or family member to complete the assignments in the next lessons, so plan accordingly!

WEEK 10 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34

WEEK 11 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 69

Jump Back, Paul

Materials: Jump Back, Paul

→ RECAP

What do you recall from the last reading?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91-100 "Now, like I said" - "he'll find you right at home."



Term 3

- Reflect back on what you read about Paul Laurence Dunbar this term - how would you describe his legacy?
 - Pause when you come to each poem and read it more than once. Reading them out loud is also a great way to get a feel for the language and cadence.
- Continue to look for patterns in the meter and rhyme scheme. What other formal patterns can you find?

→ VIEW

Take a brief tour of Paul Dunbar's home in Dayton, and read about the historic site.

∞ Link: Paul Dunbar House Historic Site

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 69

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 70

The Aeneid, cont.

📖 Materials: The Aeneid

→ RECAP

What do you recall from what you read from the Aeneid last time?

→ INTRO

In Book 11 and the beginning of Book 12, the two armies pause to bury their dead before the fighting continues. Our final reading from The Aeneid picks up at the final duel between Aeneas and Turnus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Book 12, lines 916-1113 "Now at the same moment" - "down to the shades below."

- What role do the gods play in this final confrontation?
- Why does Aeneas hesitate? What makes him change his mind?
- What do you think of how the epic ends? Why do you think Virgil decided to end the story with the moment of Turnus's death, rather than with peace and the establishment of Rome?

WEEK 11 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 70

Silas Marner

📖 Materials: Silas Marner

→ RECAP

What do recall from your reading last week?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.174-183 "Nancy and Godfrey" - "happier than we are."

- How has Lantern Hill changed in the intervening years? How has time, distance, and age altered Silas's memory of his former home?
- Why might George Eliot choose not to give Silas complete answers about William Dane's betrayal?
- What do you think of the ending of the novel? What message do you think Eliot wants us to take away from her work?

WEEK 11 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 69

📖 Materials: Activity from Lesson 68

→ PREP

Make sure you have your list of words and list of sentences on hand!

★ CLASSROOM TIP

If using these lessons in a classroom setting, students could complete the assignment with each other or as homework with a parent. Regardless, be sure to

Literature: Grade 9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ SHARE

Give a friend, classmate, family member, or teacher the list of forms you have studied over the year (skip this step if you want to make this activity harder!). Then give them your list of words from the last lesson and see if they can guess which words describe which forms. If they struggle, share your one-sentence description of each of the forms and see how they do. Then explain why you chose the words and descriptions you did.

leave room for students to share and discuss their descriptions and words with each other as students will likely have different ways of describing the various poetic forms, even though themes and some similarities should also emerge.

WEEK 11 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 70

□ Materials: The Making of a Poem

→ REVISE

Look back over the poems you wrote this year. Pick one and revise it. Now that you have had some time to read other things and let your poem rest, you may find you'd like to change words, fix the meter, etc.

→ SHARE

Of the poems you have read this year, read your favorite ones to a friend or family member. Tell why it is a favorite. As a bonus, read one of the poems YOU wrote this year!

WEEK 11 □ 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35

WEEK 12 □ 30m History of Lit: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36

WEEK 12 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
The Aeneid

WEEK 12 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 71

WEEK 12 □ 15m Poetry Reading: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Jump Back, Paul

WEEK 12 □ 30m General Lit.: Grades 9-10 - Lesson 72

WEEK 12 □ 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

Term 3

WEEK 12 15m Poetry Study: Grade 9 - Lesson 72
Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Making of a Poem

WEEK 12 30m Plays: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36

Literature: Grade 9

Examination

Term 1

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

- (Frankenstein) How are the feelings Walton describes having toward Frankenstein—such as sympathy, compassion, admiration, and pity—significant to other relationships in the novel? OR Discuss the role nature plays in the novel so far, and how it is connected to various characters' internal states.

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- Discuss some of the defining authors and characteristics of the literature written in the first half of the 1800s that we've studied so far. Organize your thoughts into at least two paragraphs.

Poetry Study: Grade 9

- Scan or turn in one of your "at-a-glance" pages in your reference guide.
- The Making of a Poem: Write a few lines about a poem you read this term. Include the name and form of the poem in your description.

Term 2

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

- (Frankenstein) One of the components in the classical definition of tragedy is that a great hero is brought down by a fatal flaw in his character. If we read the novel as the tragedy of Victor Frankenstein, what is his fatal flaw? Or would you read it as a tragedy of another character instead? OR

(From Karen Swallow Prior): How do the lines spoken by the creature to Victor upon their first meeting encapsulate the entire novel? "Remember, that I am they creature: I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel, whom thou drivest from joy for no misdeed. Every where I see bliss, from which I alone am irrevocably excluded. I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous."

- (Silas Marner) What does the gold symbolize to Marner in the beginning of the story, and how does its loss begin to change him? OR

By placing characters into situations requiring moral actions, how does Eliot shape the ethical imagination of her readers?

History of Lit: Grades 9-12

- Describe some of the genres you've studied this term and tell about one particular piece or author you read about with more detail.

Poetry Study: Grade 9

- Scan or turn in one of your "at-a-glance" pages in your reference guide.
- The Making of a Poem: Briefly explain the history of one of the poetic forms you studied this term (Sonnet, Ballad, etc.)

Term 3

General Lit.: Grades 9-10

- (Silas Marner) Do you think that Silas Marner is more of a fairy tale or a realistic novel? Give some specific examples from the novel that support your argument. OR

Provide a detailed character sketch of one of the characters from the novel. What are they like? How do they change in response to what happens to them?

Poetry Study: Grade 9

- The Making of a Poem: Scan or turn in your list of descriptions and words from lesson 68.
- The Making of a Poem: Write a few lines about a poem you read this term. Include the name and form of the poem in your description.